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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 4 : Session – 6 | Understanding 'Value' and the Program of Action

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. 'VALUE' (mulya) of a unit = its PARTICIPATION in the larger order of which it is a part. A thing is valuable in proportion to the role it plays in maintaining the harmony of the larger whole: water's value is nourishing life; a teacher's value is the student's development; a family member's value is their contribution to family harmony. For a HUMAN BEING, value = participation in the larger order at all levels — in the family (mutually fulfilling behaviour), in society (just participation), and in nature (right utilisation and protection). Value is thus not a price or a preference but a definite, existential role.
2. Q2. THE THREE-STEP PROGRAM OF ACTION for transformation: (1) SELF-EXPLORATION (swatva) — verifying the proposals of harmony within myself, on my own right, through dialogue between 'what I am' and 'what I naturally accept to be'; this yields right understanding. (2) SELF-AWARENESS (swarajya) — being continuously aware of my own activities (desire, thought, expectation) and evaluating whether they are in line with my natural acceptance; this keeps the Self self-organised in daily living. (3) SELF-EVALUATION (swatantrata expressed) — examining my behaviour, work and participation against the goal of mutual fulfilment, and correcting course. Together: understand (exploration) -> live with awareness (awareness) -> verify and improve (evaluation).
3. Q3. PAYING ATTENTION / MEDITATION in this framework means observing the Self's own activity — watching desires and thoughts arise and checking their source. B1 (based on realisation/natural acceptance): attention shows the desire is for relationship or understanding -> following it gives CONTINUOUS HAPPINESS and definiteness. B2 (based on sensation/preconditioning): attention reveals the desire as a pull of taste or social image -> following it gives TEMPORARY EXCITEMENT followed by emptiness and dependence. The RESULT of practising attention is that B2 motivations lose their grip: one sees them as they are, and choice shifts naturally toward B1 — conduct becomes self-organised rather than reactive.
4. Q4. LIVING IN THE PRESENT vs the EVER-PRESENT: 'living in the present' as commonly taught can remain at the level of sensation (enjoy this moment's taste). In this framework the Self lives in the EVER-PRESENT by standing on KNOWING — understanding that does not change with time — so each moment is evaluated against the same constant natural acceptance. Practically: I do not swing between past regret and future anxiety because my reference (right understanding of co-existence and relationship) is valid always. The ever-present is not a technique of mindfulness but the stability that comes from definite understanding.